

Kishau Multipurpose Project



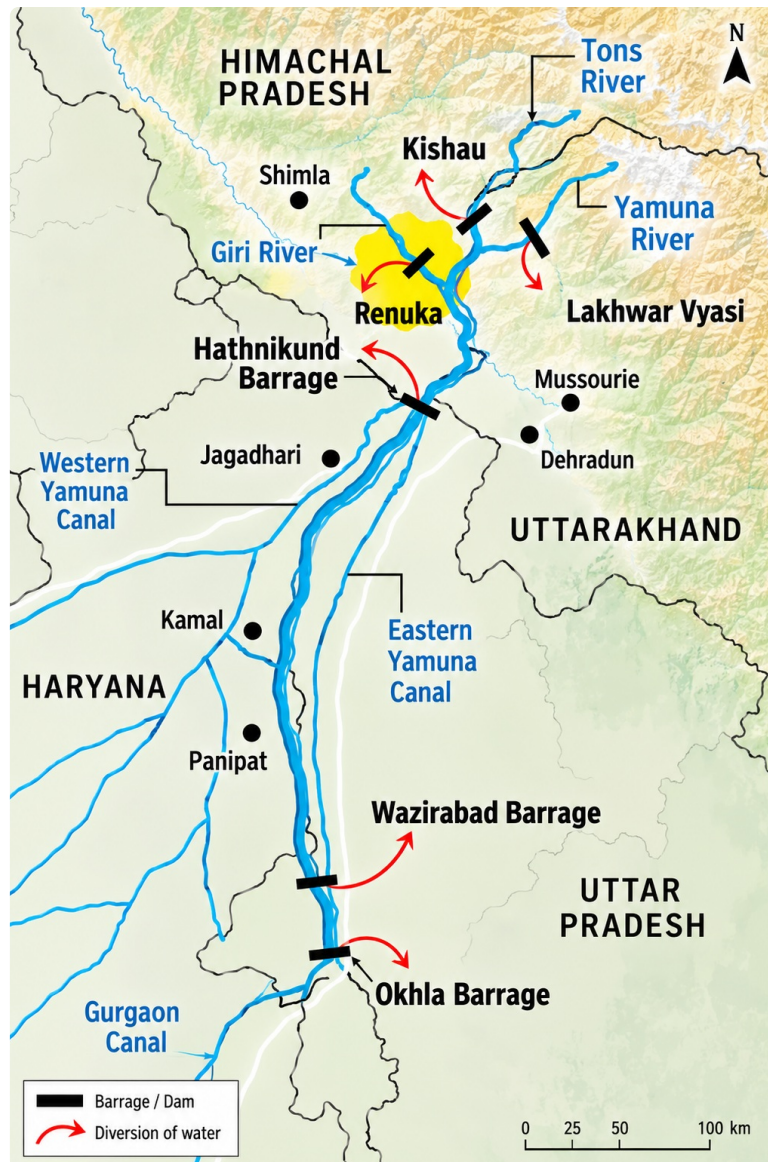
Source: IE

In a major push to resolve long-pending inter-state water disputes, six northern states **Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan, and Delhi** signed a historic Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to pave the way for the **Kishau Multipurpose Project**.

- **Background:** A MoU was signed in **1994**, between the **Yamuna basin** states (undivided Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, and Delhi) regarding the allocation of the river's surface water.
 - Because the Upper Yamuna (from its source at the Yamunotri glacier to the Okhla barrage in Delhi) lacked major storage facilities, the **1994 agreement mandated the creation** of three major storage projects on the Yamuna and its tributaries:
 - **Lakhwar Project:** On the Yamuna River (Uttarakhand).
 - **Renukaji Project:** On the Giri River (Himachal Pradesh).
 - **Kishau Project:** On the Tons River (Himachal Pradesh/Uttarakhand border).
- **Kishau Multipurpose Project:** The Kishau Multipurpose Project entails the construction of a 232.6-metre-high concrete gravity dam on the **Tons river** (a major tributary of the Yamuna) situated along the Uttarakhand-Himachal Pradesh border.
- **Dispute:** Designated as a National Project, the **Centre funds 90% of the water component**, with the remaining 10% shared among the basin states under the 1994 Yamuna framework.
 - However, the dispute centered on the **power component**, where Himachal Pradesh refused to bear its estimated **Rs 2,000-crore liability**, arguing that it was unfair to impose this fiscal burden on the state when it was already shouldering the **displacement and ecological costs while downstream states** received most of the water and irrigation benefits.
- **Breakthrough:** A consensus was reached through **"cooperative federalism."** To relieve Himachal Pradesh's financial constraints, the beneficiary downstream states agreed to cover its power-component liability.
 - According to the agreement, Delhi (biggest beneficiary of the project) and Rajasthan will bear this expense in a 75:25 ratio, as they are major beneficiaries of the water supply.
- **Socio-Economic Outcomes:** The **422-MW project** is designed to generate **1,476 million units of hydropower** and will create vast irrigation potential covering **97,000 hectares** of agricultural land.
- **Water Security for the Capital:** **Delhi stands to be the biggest beneficiary**, receiving **110 million cubic metres (MCM) of water**, which will provide critical, long-term support for the city's drinking water needs.
- **Environmental Rejuvenation:** Correcting historical allocation flaws, **25% of the project's water** is

strictly dedicated to maintaining the **environmental flow of the Yamuna river** .

- This is a crucial step toward the government's target of achieving a completely **clean Yamuna by 2029** , which is linked to the **National Mission for Clean Ganga (NMCG)** .



Read more: [Kishau Multipurpose Dam Project](#)

Sanjukta Parasor: 1st Woman Officer to Lead CRPF's CoBRA Unit



Source: IE

Senior IPS officer **Sanjukta Parasor** has been appointed as the **first woman Inspector General (IG) of the CRPF's elite Commando Battalion for Resolute Action (CoBRA) unit** , marking a significant milestone in India's security forces. She will succeed 1996-batch IPS officer Danesh Rana.

- **About:** A 2006-batch IPS officer, she is known as the **"Iron Lady of Assam"** for her counter-insurgency work in the Northeast, involving field policing, national security operations and handling of insurgency-related challenges.
 - She previously served as a **Deputy Inspector General in the National Investigation Agency (NIA)** , working on terrorism and extremism-related investigations.
- **Significance:** Her appointment marks a milestone in **women's leadership in India's security forces** , particularly in specialised counter-insurgency and jungle warfare operations.

About CoBRA

- The **Commando Battalion for Resolute Action (CoBRA)** is a specialised unit of the **Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)** established to conduct **jungle warfare and guerrilla operations** , particularly against Maoist insurgency. Its personnel are selected from the CRPF and receive intensive training in commando tactics and jungle warfare.
- **Formation and Deployment:** A total of **10 CoBRA units were raised between 2008 and 2011** . These battalions are deployed in **Left Wing Extremism (LWE) -affected and insurgency-prone areas** across states such as Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Jharkhand, Maharashtra, Assam and Meghalaya.
- **Role and Capabilities:** CoBRA specialises in **anti-Naxal operations, intelligence-based missions, long-range patrols, ambush and counter-ambush operations** in challenging terrains, making it one of the CRPF's key specialised operational forces.



Read More: [CRPF's New Operations Base in Chhattisgarh](#)

National Conference on Quality and Safety of Biosimilars



Source: PIB

Recently, the **Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC)** organised a two-day National conference on **“Quality and Safety of Biosimilars: Strengthening India’s Biopharma SHAKTI Vision”** in **Bengaluru** focusing on strengthening India’s biopharmaceutical ecosystem through quality, innovation and regulatory excellence.

- The conference focused on **improving the quality, safety, regulatory evaluation and development of biosimilars** through collaboration among regulators, industry, academia and research organisations.
- IPC released the **Indian Pharmacopoeia Reference Substance (IPRS)** for Enoxaparin Sodium for bioassays, providing an authenticated reference material for accurate and consistent testing of biological activity.
- **About IPC:** IPC is an **autonomous institution under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare** responsible for developing standards for medicines and strengthening pharmaceutical quality infrastructure.

Biosimilars

- **About: Biosimilars** are highly similar versions of approved biological medicines that provide safe and effective treatment options for various conditions, including **cancer, arthritis, kidney diseases, psoriasis, Crohn’s disease and colitis** .
- **Benefits:** They help improve **patient access to essential medicines** by offering additional treatment options and may reduce healthcare costs.
- **Biopharma SHAKTI Vision:** It was announced in the **Union Budget 2025-26** , with an **outlay of ₹10,000 crore over five years to strengthen India’s ecosystem for biologics and biosimilars**, promote domestic manufacturing and reduce import dependence.
- **Research and Clinical Infrastructure:** The initiative focuses on expanding biopharma capabilities through the establishment of **three new National Institutes of Pharmaceutical Education and Research (NIPERs)** , upgradation of **seven existing NIPERs** , and creation of **over 1,000 accredited clinical trial sites** to support research, innovation and clinical development.

Read More: [Biopharma SHAKTI Scheme](#)